ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** underestimates Grandpa	She believes he is forgetful.
2	**(b)** stealth	Tiptoed.
3	**(a)** isn't he	Positive statement, negative tag.
4	**(d)** mixture of duty and curiosity	Both.
5	**(a)** it lets us see both Ravi and Mother's views	Wider view.
6	**(c)** Ravi followed Grandpa and Grandpa smiled.	Two main clauses.
7	**(c)** had noticed Ravi all along	He knew.
8	**(d)** simile	Uses 'like'.
9	**(b)** amusement	Noun form.
10	**(d)** the gap between what the family believes and what is true	Irony.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He notices Ravi's following (1) and cleverly turns it into a joke (1).	1+1
12	Teasing replaces anger (1) so the lesson is learnt gently (1).	1+1
13	It sounds like a lullaby (1) and adds tenderness (1).	1+1
14	A memory vitamin is wished for the old (1) but the mother is the one who forgets (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She remains anxious (1). She laughs on discovering her own mistake (1). She learns to see Grandpa fairly (1).	1+1+1
16	Grandpa reveals he knew (1). The joke makes it funny (1). It leaves a warm feeling (1).	1+1+1
17	Grandpa was on the ball (1). He teased the family with the Vitamin-M joke (1). Meanings: alert; tease (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Ravi might be caught (1). Grandpa may turn back (1). We wonder what he will do (1).	1+1+1
18	Title says he cannot remember (1). Yet images appear (1). The contrast shows love stronger than forgetting (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Story mother is anxious and forgetful (1). Poem mother is absent and remembered (1). Both show how a mother shapes a child's world (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Comic chase (1). Mother's irony (1). Grandpa's wit (1). The serious point about dignity (1). The warm ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Story: memory as a worry and a joke (1). Poem: memory as love (1). Memory is not only facts (1). Small things trigger it (1). Memory builds family bonds (1).	2+2+1
20	Mother's worries (1). Grandpa's independence (1). Ravi's role between them (1). Misunderstanding and its resolution (1). Lesson for readers (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Imagery (1). Tone (1). Language (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.

- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** nature and everyday things	Sensory memory.
2	**(b)** should	Duty.
3	**(c)** Age does not reduce dignity or wit	Dignity.
4	**(b)** central idea	Theme.
5	**(c)** watch closely	Monitor.
6	**(b)** situational irony	She forgets while fearing for Grandpa.
7	**(c)** a child or an adult recalling childhood	Childhood memory.
8	**(a)** The cake was baked by Mother.	Was baked.
9	**(b)** it turns the 'forgetful' label back on the mother	Humour with a point.
10	**(d)** a sincere and intimate tone	Intimacy.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He loves Ravi (1) and wants to teach with humour (1).	1+1
12	It focuses on love, not anger (1). Memory brings comfort (1).	1+1
13	It hurts a person's dignity (1) and shows lack of trust (1).	1+1
14	A faint memory of a lullaby floats in his mind (1) while he plays (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	They give Ravi places to hide (1). They suit a gentle chase (1). Ordinary places make humour real (1).	1+1+1
16	It is a constant presence (1). It links past and present (1). It brings his mother near (1).	1+1+1
17	A tune shows her voice (1). A scent shows her presence (1). The sky shows her gaze (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Age does not end the wish for freedom (1). Old people can manage many tasks (1). Respect strengthens their spirit (1).	1+1+1
18	By simple honest words (1). By a universal theme (1). By gentle images (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Respect and cherish elders (1). Value memories (1). Appreciate parents (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	He goes out alone (1). He teases (1). He makes the closing joke (1). He resents being supervised (1). We see his mind and dignity (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). Recall the day (1). Teasing and thanks (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Meaning of Vitamin-M (1). Mother's belief (1). Her forgetfulness (1). Grandpa's alertness (1). The title reverses the expected (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). Elder introduced (1). Misjudgement (1). Surprise (1). Lesson (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.

- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** protecting too much	Over- = too much.
2	**(c)** by quietly teasing Ravi	Gentle teasing.
3	**(b)** a persistent sense of loss	Loss.
4	**(a)** The man whom Ravi followed was Grandpa.	Object form.
5	**(a)** reflect on how they treat elders	Message.
6	**(c)** faint and floating	Hover.
7	**(c)** Old is gold	Relevant.
8	**(d)** respect	Equal treatment.
9	**(b)** was	Backshift.
10	**(a)** story and poem both, in different ways	Both.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The story shows love through teasing (1). The poem shows love through memory (1).	1+1
12	He links Mother's worry and Grandpa's reality (1). His following leads to the funny ending (1).	1+1
13	The scent of flowers and the sky bring back feeling (1). Nature becomes a bridge to the past (1).	1+1
14	In the story, a birthday joke reveals who is forgetful (1). In the poem, a tune evokes a mother (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Funny chase (1). Serious point about dignity (1). The ending joins both (1).	1+1+1
16	Ravi asked where Grandpa was going (1). Question becomes a statement (1). Present continuous changes to past continuous (1).	1+1+1
17	Nature gives sensory triggers (1). Memories wake through them (1). Nature keeps love alive (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It shows misjudgement (1). It builds irony (1). The reader learns with Ravi (1).	1+1+1
18	Although Ravi was afraid, he kept following Grandpa (1). Subordinate clause with 'although' (1). Main clause states action (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Grandpa's quiet joke (1). No scolding (1). Meaning is understood without speech (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Greeting (1). Grandpa's example (1). Family attitudes (1). Why elders matter (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Story is humorous prose (1). Poem is lyrical (1). Story uses dialogue (1). Poem uses images (1). Both are gentle and warm (1).	2+2+1
20	Tune (1). Scent (1). Sky (1). Simple words (1). Effect of tender longing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Listen (1). Give independence (1). Talk openly (1). Show respect (1). Use humour kindly (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.

- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND